



Hook into a Book

Grandad's Island

A Mysterious Letter



Activity

Children will investigate a letter from a mysterious sender.

This Hook into a Book pack is designed to be used as an introduction to your scheme of work on Grandad's Island by Benji Davies. It could be used before beginning to read the text or when you have started reading and are about to embark on a writing unit.



Preparation

Prepare an original copy of **A Mysterious Letter** inside an envelope with the class name written on it. Consider how the letter will be delivered to the room once the children are in class if this is how you would like to arrange it.

Before the lesson, you may wish to prepare copies of the letter or you could do this during the lesson to keep the letter more mysterious.



Overview

Explain to the children that a mysterious letter has just been delivered to the classroom. Alternatively, you may wish to have the letter arrive during the lesson so that the children can see it being delivered.

Read the letter aloud to the class and provide the children plenty of time to discuss their ideas around it.

Question Ideas

- Why do you think this letter was sent to us?
- Who is the author's friend?
- Why do you think we need to check on Syd?



You will need:

- **A Mysterious Letter**
- **Lesson Presentation**
- an envelope addressed to the class with the letter inside
- copies of the **A Mysterious Letter** for the children to read (you may wish to do this during the lesson so that the children continue to believe the letter has only just arrived)



Activity

Give the children large pieces of paper to work on in small groups or write down ideas individually on sticky notes.

Additionally, you may wish to reveal the book and the blurb at the end of the session and have the children write down their predictions about what they think will happen in the story. An optional slide has been added at the end of the **Lesson Presentation** for this.